“Temptations”
I became skin and bones and my bones thinly wore my skin,
We shared conversations at unexplainable times in the morning,
About how you were me as a kid and I was you,
And how some people change for the better yet we changed for the worse,
But some people don’t change at all
The same egomaniac bangs at your door for rent
The same masochist settles for you because they know you close off.

The temptations they’re unable to resist but I could resist them in their shoes,
Out of sight,
Out of mind,
But the mind overconsumes what it can’t control
I became skin and bones and my bones thinly wore my skin
I became all of you when you wore part of me like you wore your shirts as a fashion statement
There’s no water around but I’m drowning in what you prioritize me in

I became skin and bones and my bones thinly wore my skin
I threw away all of you that I managed to but I ache for all of you
I craved you lustfully and lovingly but I need all of you
You’re unmanageable to hold onto,
Waiting will do no good now,

I became skin and bones and my bones thinly wore my skin,
I suffocated myself in an atmosphere I was nonexistent in,
Words are just words,
Actions are just actions,
Boys will be boys,
Until it’s me and you and suddenly the light in my eyes pitched a spark again.

“Divisional” - Performed at state-wide poetry slam

Make me a vulture, god please, so I can feed on what’s left of you.
I have sweat and blood on my hands that aren’t mine,
Extend my limbs until I can no longer see you eye to eye,
Further me deeper into your palms as your illusions multiple.

Make me a vulture, god please, so I can revolve myself around you.
Bodily fluids pouring out and over me,
But ignorance is bliss so I stand neutralized.
From transcontinental railroads to overproduction of everyday products,
I need you and I “thrive” off of you,
But you aren’t worth a dime of my patientless time.

Make me a vulture, god please, so I can redefine myself around the basis of your culture.
Stitched together from broken praise and hollow virtue like a ruined sculpture.
You stay a temporary meaning for me until a legal replacement arrives,
And then it’s off with you until you get back denied.

Make me a vulture, god please, so parts of me can decompress,
Rip me open and consume my thin flesh,
Tear my wounded heart right out of my vulnerable chest.
Sell me to a multi-millionate to brand me into an expensive vest,
Erase the varieties of me that I managed to keep painted on the mutuals of this country,
And silence me,
Until I can taste the end of my journey.

“The Sightseer”
I threw away my academic accomplishments,
As if they were dingy rubber bands and hair ties I used to flick on my suffocated wrist
I witnessed the immense favoritism between a writer, a poet, and a scientist.
I felt the loose ends following me back home,
Sectioned out strings that trailed like a ghost child,
I failed to leave that part of myself behind.
I was terrified to let go,
The only part that loved me oh so,
I carried her on my weakened shoulders.
I watched the garbage truck ride away
Knowing that who I yearned to be was sliding out the back.

“Detachment”
And I kept you so close but too far so I could feel the tensions between us
So I could admire you from the distance but not too far so you could notice me in the haze
I kept all the perfect parts of you I tended to cherish more than others,
I fell for the aspect of you that I needed to keep

And I watched you from across the train tracks fall in love with another desire,
Another individual,
She was everything I couldn’t exist myself to be as
And I kept you so close but too far,
But somehow close enough so you could still acknowledge our peace
I watched you thrive in the aftermath while I dealt with a self-slow burn
I wish I could’ve kept you closer so you could feel my heart pounding of regret

“Repetition”
Repeating alliteration, I felt only aggravation
Unspoken words with treasury worth more than an approximate urgency,
Allusions in my adolescence, an automatic antibody that could've never formed internally,
Anxious apologies arranged along abandoned avenues of memories,
Ageless aromas awaken an absent ache across my unappealing anatomy,
And ambiguous answers arise as another accusation attacks my needed sanity.
Abrasive and out of place thoughts aggravate an environment and mindset I'm at home in yet feel unsafe in,
Artificial affection appears as an anonymous anomaly,
Aching admiration always avoids an actual apology,
Ancient anxieties assemble and attach against my agency,
An accidental agreement allows another avalanche of agony,
Apathetic actions add an alarming amount of agony,
At last, an adaptable acceptance arrives and alters my vessels.